



CONTRACTOR GUIDE

Contracting at *Vantage Meridian*

A guide for contractors joining the Vantage Meridian delivery network.



vantagemeridian.com.au

One company, *one contract.*

Thanks for your interest in contracting with Vantage Meridian. This guide explains how the network works, how you will be engaged when a role lands, what you need to have in place and how you get paid. It is worth ten minutes now so there are no surprises later.

Vantage Meridian is not an agency. It is a Brisbane-based delivery consultancy, led by its director and principal, Sky Lavelle. Sky wins the engagements through competitive government and enterprise tenders and delivers them with a principal-led team drawn from a small network of practitioners he knows and rates. When you contract with Vantage Meridian, you deal with the person who won the work and leads the delivery: one company, one contract, one point of contact and no margin stacking through layers of agencies.

One

One contract and one point of contact – no margin stacking through layers of agencies

Five / four

Five phases and four gates in the Vantage Meridian Delivery Framework

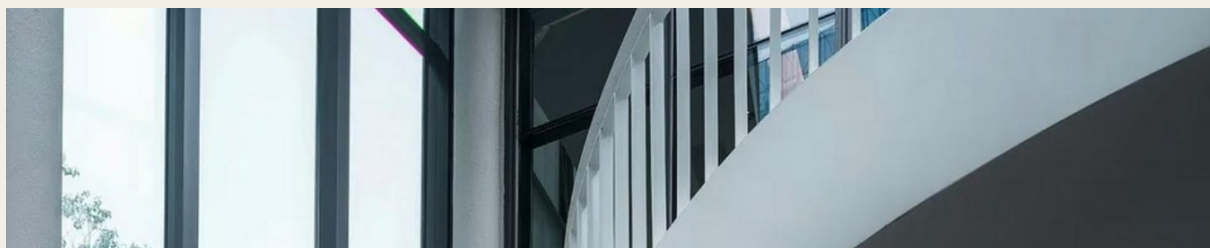
Month end

A fixed monthly pay day, so you always know when money lands

ABOUT VANTAGE MERIDIAN

A defined method *behind every seat.*

Vantage Meridian provides senior project delivery, procurement governance and enterprise technology transformation, grounded in twenty years of complex program delivery across media and broadcasting, higher education and cyber security and government-adjacent research. Engagements run on the Vantage Meridian Delivery Framework – five phases, four gates, one hybrid discipline – so the delivery you join has a defined, repeatable method behind it and every seat on the team works under the principal's hands-on oversight.



HOW YOU WILL BE ENGAGED

From tender *to delivery.*

Vantage Meridian engages contractors when it has won an engagement and has a confirmed role to place them into. Being part of the network costs you nothing and commits you to nothing; it means that when a tender goes in, it goes in with a real team behind it.

01

Tender and consent

When an opportunity fits your skills, we will contact you before anything is submitted – to confirm your interest, your availability window and your consent to be put forward. Client documents describe the team by role; your details are only shared with your agreement.

02

Win and placement

If Vantage Meridian wins and the role is confirmed, you sign either the Vantage Meridian Independent Contractor Agreement or a Vantage Meridian employment contract, together with a schedule recording the role, client, location, rate, term and notice period for that placement.

03

Onboarding

You complete the short onboarding pack – including any client background checks. Your start date may be conditional on those clearing.

04

Delivery

You deliver on the client engagement under our delivery oversight, with day-to-day direction from the client. Extensions are handled with a fresh Engagement Schedule, but the master agreement stays in place between assignments.

Company or *employee*.

You can join a Vantage Meridian engagement in one of two ways: through your own company, which subcontracts to Vantage Meridian, or as an employee of Vantage Meridian. There is no right answer – it depends on your circumstances and you should talk to your accountant before deciding.

	Your own company	Employee
Structure	Your own incorporated company subcontracts to Vantage Meridian, and you are its "Key Person".	Vantage Meridian employs you directly and places you on the client engagement.
Setup	Company registration, ABN, GST registration, company bank account. More admin and cost; can be more tax-effective.	No company or ABN needed. You provide a tax file number declaration, super choice and bank details.
Signing	Company signs the agreement; you also sign a short Key Person Undertaking.	You sign an employment contract and its schedule – no separate undertaking.
Tax and super	Your company manages its own tax, super and workers' compensation obligations, and invoices at your daily rate.	Vantage Meridian withholds PAYG tax, pays superannuation and provides paid leave. You are paid through payroll.

Insurances

- Own company: You will need professional indemnity insurance before you start on site, plus public liability insurance and workers' compensation as required by law for your structure.
- Employee: Vantage Meridian's own policies cover you, including workers' compensation. There is nothing for you to arrange.

Certificates of currency are collected during onboarding and at each renewal if you contract through your own company. If you are quoting for insurance for the first time, mention you are an IT or professional services contractor – it is a standard, inexpensive class of cover.

What to have *ready*.

When a placement is confirmed, Vantage Meridian will send you a short pack. You will need to return:

- **Vantage Meridian Required Information Form**

Your contact and bank details, plus company and ABN details, or a tax file number declaration and super choice if you join as an employee.

- **Vantage Meridian Candidate Declaration Form**

Declarations covering right to work, conflicts and background.

- **Signed agreement and schedule**

Independent Contractor Agreement and Engagement Schedule with the key person undertaking, or your employment contract and its schedule.

- **Certificates of currency**

For each of your insurances, if you contract through your own company.

- **Right-to-work and client checks**

Identity, police, qualifications and references. Client work, especially government, can be conditional on these clearing.



Paid monthly, *on a fixed day.*

Vantage Meridian pays monthly on a fixed pay day, so you always know when money lands.

Weekly

Complete your timesheet in the system nominated for your assignment and submit it for client approval by 5.00pm Friday.

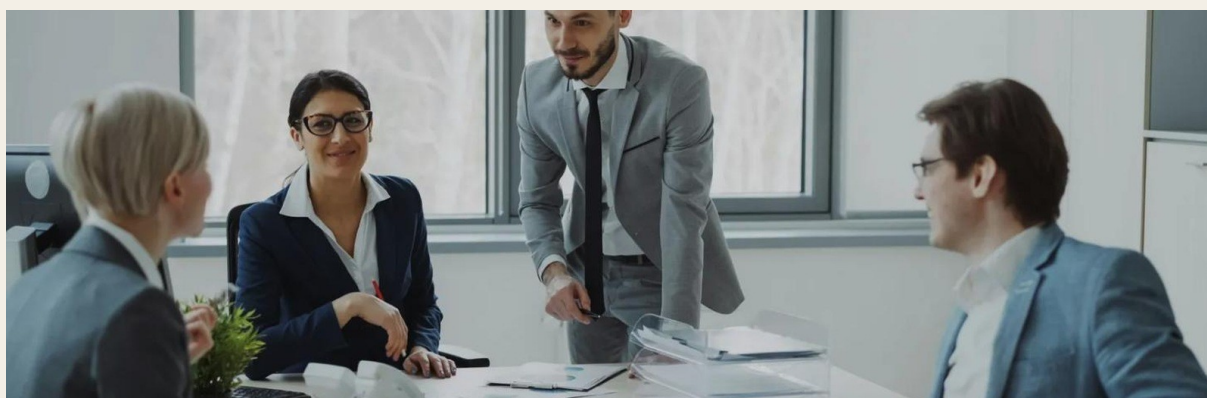
Monthly

If you contract through your own company, email a valid tax invoice (entity, ABN, period, days, rate, GST if registered, total) to engagement@vantagemeridian.com.au by the last business day of the month. Employees do not invoice.

Pay day

Payment is made on the last business day of the month following the month in which the work was performed. Salaries run on the same cycle.

The exact invoice deadlines and pay dates for every month are set out in the Vantage Meridian Contractor Payment Schedule (July 2026 to June 2027), which you receive with your contract. Days not client-approved at processing time roll into the next month's run, so keep your weekly timesheets up to date.



Keeping the *reputation intact*.

A few things keep the network's reputation (and yours) intact on site:

- Follow the client's policies, code of conduct and safety requirements and complete any client inductions.
- Treat everything you see and produce as confidential; client material stays on client systems unless you have written approval.
- Your daily rate is confidential between you and Vantage Meridian – never discuss it with client staff or other contractors.
- Raise problems early. Call Sky before anything becomes an issue on site, whether it's delivery friction, scope trouble or anything that feels off.
- Public comment, including social media posts about the client or the engagement, needs written approval first.

Lavelle Pty Ltd (ACN 651 199 414) trading as Vantage Meridian. ABN 27 651 199 414.
Brisbane, Queensland – working nationally.